

2026 | Session 2 – COMP8240: Applications of Data Science

Assessment Task #1: Project Proposal

Submission details	
Due Date	11.55pm 09/10/26 Week 9
Weighting	Assessment will be marked out of a total of 40 marks. This assessment will contribute to 40% of overall unit grade.
Time to complete	This assessment will take approximately 20 hours to complete.
Length & Format	<i>Format:</i> A video presentation in MP4 format. <i>Length:</i> 5 minutes.
Late Penalties	Standard late penalty applies.
How to Submit	iLearn dropbox
Return of Assessment Grade & Feedback	Grades and feedback will be returned via iLearn, target timeframe 2 weeks from submission date.
Purpose	The overall purpose of the semester-long project is to develop and demonstrate capabilities in replicating a piece of research work, as is typically necessary in carrying out research involving computational experiments, using open source tools in industry, etc. In this specific assessment, you will produce a video that gives an update on your progress on the project chosen at the project proposal stage.
Learning Outcomes Assessed	On successful completion you will be able to: • ULO01 Define and manage a project involving empirical research. • ULO02 Apply a knowledge of programming and/or use of appropriate applications (for e.g. data gathering, curation, cleaning or analysis) in the context of practical work relevant to an empirical research project. • ULO03 Articulate clearly a coherent argument in written and oral form to a variety of audiences.
Skills assessed	Using the methods and tools described in Lectures and SGTAs, this task allows you to demonstrate: 1. your oral communication skills; 2. your ability to recognise research that is likely to be reproducible, and to understand the core aspects of that paper that are involved in reproducibility; 3. your ability to define and manage a project involving empirical research; and 4. your ability to use tools typically used in the conduct and presentation of empirical computational research.
How will this task be assessed?	Individual
Use of AI	Open. Note that in using generative AI, you are responsible for its output, and for the relevant assessed aspects of the proposal document. For example, in this assessment you may use generative AI to suggest references, but you are

	expected to read all references to determine their relevance and correctness with respect to your topic.
Short automated extensions	Accepted.

Task overview

For this assessment, you will produce a video as outlined in the instructions below.

Task details / specific instructions

Goal

The goal of this assessment is to produce a project update presentation that provides an update on how your project is progressing. You are required to create a 5-minute video presentation in MP4 format.

In this video presentation, you should provide a recap of what your project is about (about half the presentation time, perhaps slightly more). As for the proposal presentation, if you are doing the default project, you will primarily be explaining what data you will be using and where it will come from. If you are doing a novel project, you will remind the audience what it is about.

For the update component (the other half of the presentation time, perhaps slightly less), you will tell the audience about your progress in getting your chosen system working, and (most importantly) how your construction of new datasets is progressing.

The rest of this document should be read in conjunction with the Overall Goal and Assessment Criteria for the project. The rest of this document should be read in conjunction with the [Overall Goal and Assessment Criteria](#) [this is similarly an iLearn link to the page of this name] for the project.

Content

Default Project

Following is an augmented recap from the proposal requirements. Note again that the maximum mark possible for the Default Project is 80%.

In terms of the Overall Goal and Assessment Criteria for the project as a whole, you will focus in this presentation on the following two criteria:

- *Replication of original work:* As getting one of the three default projects to work is fairly straightforward, this will be fairly brief. Just describe the current progress with respect to the default project, and the environment where you are running that project. In your video presentation introduce the high-level architecture of the system, run the code, and explain the output of the system.

- *New data:* For this task, you would typically aim for at least one new existing dataset and one entirely newly constructed dataset. You should describe where this data will come from, and what its properties are. Constructing new datasets that require more work to create are more interesting and worth more marks.
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For the update: Tell audience how the replication on original data went, and about the progress on construction of the new dataset.

Novel Project

Following is an augmented recap from the proposal requirements.

In addition to the criteria for the default project, there is more required in terms of the overall project assessment criteria.

- *Justification for project basis:* Check what's expected under Overall Goal and Assessment Criteria. In addition to justifying the choice of work by some indicator of quality, you'll also need to convince the audience of the feasibility of the project. Is the code accessible and does it look likely to be able to be successfully implemented? Is the original data introduced in the paper actually available? *For the update:* You don't need to do a full justification again: just remind the audience where the work comes from (publication venue, source of code, etc).
 - *Replication of original work:* This will outline what is necessary for implementation of the original work. In your video presentation introduce the high-level architecture of the system, run the code, and explain the output of the system.
 - *New data:* As above, datasets that require more work to create are more interesting and worth more marks.
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For the update: Tell the audience how the replication on original data went, and about the progress on construction of the new dataset.

Suggested Timing for your Video Presentation

Default Project

Total: 5 minutes

Recap of Project ($\approx$ 2.5-3 minutes)

0:00-0:30 -- Brief introduction, remind audience of project goal.

0:30-1:30 -- Explain dataset(s) from original paper (where it comes from, why it's used).

1:30-2:30 -- High-level architecture of system; run original code (if possible) & show output.

Update / Progress ($\approx$ 2-2.5 minutes)

2:30-3:15 -- Explain replication status (Does the code work? In what environment? Did you get similar results?).

3:15-4:15 -- Describe new datasets: at least one existing + one you're constructing (sources, properties, challenges).

4:15-5:00 -- Progress update on dataset construction (collection, preprocessing, annotation).

Wrap-up ($\approx$ 15 seconds)

Re-emphasise key progress points and what comes next.

Novel Project

Total: 5 minutes

Recap of Project & Justification ($\approx$ 2.5-3 minutes)

0:00-0:30 -- Remind audience of project basis (publication venue, authors, why you chose it).

0:30-1:15 -- Explain dataset(s) from original paper (where it comes from, why it's used).

1:15-2:45 -- High-level system architecture; mention source code availability and feasibility, run original code (if possible) & show output.

Update / Progress ($\approx$ 2-2.5 minutes)

2:45-3:30 -- Status of replication on original data (Does the code work? In what environment? Did you get similar results?).

3:30-4:30 -- Describe your new datasets: at least one existing, one you are constructing (detail properties, challenges).

4:30-4:50 -- Progress on construction (collection, preprocessing, annotation).

Wrap-up ($\approx$ 10-15 seconds)

Re-emphasise key progress points and what comes next.

Tips for Delivery

- Keep explanations high-level and avoid technical overload -- focus on progress.
 - Show your face in a corner window during screen sharing (required).
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Quality Criteria

A high-quality submission:

- is well-structured with clear sections and logical flow, along the lines of the suggested structures above;
- has clear descriptions of the code and the data you are working with;
- has sufficient detail for us to assess the extent of your progress, including what has and has not worked in your replication to this point;
- is clear on both existing datasets and proposed new datasets.

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The rubric below guides you to what we expect.

Assessment Component	Outstanding High Distinction (100%-85%)	Advanced Distinction (84%-75%)	Proficient Credit (74%-65%)	Functional Pass (64%-50%)	Developing Fail (49%-0%)
Recap / Justification (<i>novel project</i> : 6 marks; <i>default project</i> : 4 marks)	<i>Novel project</i> : Clear, concise recap & strong justification (source, feasibility). <i>Default project</i> : Clear recap of project goals.	<i>Novel project</i> : As HD, but one element is not as strong (e.g. justification is weaker, recap is less clear). <i>Default project</i> : Mostly clear recap of project goals.	<i>Novel project</i> : As D, but two elements are not as strong (e.g. justification is weaker, recap is less clear on not concise). <i>Default project</i> : Fairly clear recap of project goals.	<i>Novel project</i> : Presents enough recap and justification for the watcher to have an idea about what the project is about and why it is worthwhile. <i>Default project</i> : Presents enough recap for the watcher to have an idea about what the project is about.	Does not present enough recap (and justification where appropriate) for the watcher to have an idea about what the project is about (and why it is worthwhile, where appropriate).
Replication of Original Work (<i>novel project</i> : 8 marks; <i>default project</i> : 6 marks)	Explanation of replication progress is very clear, leaving no questions.	Explanation of replication progress is generally good, leaving perhaps one or two questions.	Explanation of replication progress is missing some details.	Explanation of replication progress gives an overall picture with some detail.	Explanation of replication progress is unclear or missing.
New Data – Description (<i>novel project</i> : 8 marks; <i>default project</i> : 6 marks)	Detailed description of new datasets (source, properties, complexity), leaving no questions.	Detailed description of new datasets (source, properties, complexity), leaving perhaps one or two questions.	Fairly solid description of new datasets (source, properties, complexity) but missing some details.	Description of new datasets gives an overall picture with some detail.	Description of new datasets is unclear or missing.
New Data – Progress (<i>novel project</i> : 8 marks; <i>default project</i> : 6 marks)	Evidence of progress in dataset that you are constructing with respect to collection, preprocessing, annotation, leaving no questions.	Evidence of progress in dataset that you are constructing with respect to collection, preprocessing, annotation, leaving perhaps one or two questions.	Evidence of progress in dataset that you are constructing with respect to collection, preprocessing, annotation, but missing some details.	Evidence of progress in dataset that you are constructing (with respect to collection, preprocessing, annotation) gives an overall picture with some detail.	Evidence of progress in dataset that you are constructing (with respect to collection, preprocessing, annotation) is poor or missing.
Presentation Quality (10 marks)	Clarity, structure, timing balance (5 minutes +/- 10%), engagement, audio/visual quality are excellent.	Clarity, structure, timing balance (5 minutes +/- 10%), engagement, audio/visual quality are generally very good, perhaps lacking in one or two areas.	Clarity, structure, timing balance (5 minutes +/- 10%), engagement, audio/visual quality are good, lacking in two or more areas.	Clarity, structure, timing balance (5 minutes +/- 10%), engagement, audio/visual quality are satisfactory.	Clarity, structure, timing balance (5 minutes +/- 10%), engagement, audio/visual quality are broadly unsatisfactory.